

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Artie Ficial

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met.

- Works closely with **Claire O'Scuro**. **Claire** keeps asking why the exhibition needs quite so much theater.
- Relies on **Monet Bags** for the budget and **Sue Venir** for donor agreements.
- Trusts **Brie DeVivre** to handle the donors when Artie gets pulled into a crisis.

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Artie Ficial. It is my pleasure to welcome you to our gala unveiling our newest exhibition, Treasures of the World, sponsored by our generous benefactor, Grant Larceny, who will arrive here shortly. I'm confident this will be a remarkable evening, and if anything goes wrong tonight, please treat it as an immersive experience.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant had privately informed you that tonight's gift would come with a new governance agreement: he wanted veto power over acquisitions, his name on the museum, and your resignation within sixty days. You smiled through the meeting and told no one.

Your other secret

You have already accepted a confidential offer to lead a rival museum next year, which makes any argument with Grant look like succession planning.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Monet Bags has seen the governance addendum.
- Quietly learn whether Claire O'Scuro would stay if you left.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *The moving-picture gallery has a secret on its unseen side.*
- 2 *Success stands on a pedestal. Tonight the prize is underneath the prize.*
- 3 *A lamp dressed in green is illuminating the neighborhood of a secret.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

ACT I: MOTIVE



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Grant wanted my resignation attached to his donation, like a complimentary tote bag. I had accepted a job at a rival museum. There, I've said it. I kept smiling because thirty years of museum management teaches you to applaud while someone repossesses your chair. I began revising the acknowledgments with the board chair at 6:36.

IF MURDERER

Grant wanted my resignation attached to his donation, like a complimentary tote bag. I had accepted a job at the rival museum, but leaving meant handing him this institution. I told him he could purchase a wing. He could not purchase my surrender. I began revising the acknowledgments with the board chair at 6:29.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The speakerphone is fixed to the boardroom wall. She read each donor name, I answered, and we kept revising together until her final correction. The acknowledgments were my last duty before Grant's announcement. His name appeared eleven times. I reduced that to nine, which he considered an attack on the donation. The speech cards are in my handwriting, including the crossed-out title he awarded himself.

IF MURDERER

The speakerphone is fixed to the boardroom wall. She read each donor name, I answered, and we kept revising together until her final correction. The acknowledgments were my last duty before Grant's announcement. His name appeared eleven times. I reduced that to nine, which he considered an attack on the donation. The speech cards are in my handwriting, including the crossed-out title he awarded himself.



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Artie Ficial

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Artie Ficial

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

The chair's final correction came at 6:46. The pocket square and speech cards went with me to Grant afterward. I could spell his name. What I couldn't do was persuade him that the other names mattered.

IF MURDERER

The chair's final correction came at 6:38. The pocket square and speech cards went with me to Grant afterward. I could spell his name. What I couldn't do was persuade him that the other names mattered.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Artie Ficial

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The rival museum is real. I was leaving, and I let Grant think I might still accept his terms because I wanted the board to see what he demanded. My conversation with the chair lasted across the full uncovered-glass period on the fixed boardroom phone. I concealed a career move, not a trip to his glass. Tomorrow I will submit my resignation on my own stationery.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I murdered Grant. During the preparation walkthrough I took cyanide from the open room and hid it in my pocket square. While the glass was uncovered, I brought his corrected speech cards to the Salon and wiped the solution inside his glass. The glass cover and the pour finished the service exactly as planned. He wanted my resignation. I gave him a farewell toast instead.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.